

SPEAKING A2 – TOPIC 6: *DREAM HOUSE*

PART 1: INTERVIEW

1. What's your name? Can I see your ID?
2. Where are you from?
3. Do you live in a house or an apartment?
4. How long have you lived there?
5. What do you like about living there?

PART 2: LONG TURN

Describe a house you would like to live in

You should say:

- *Where it would be*
- *What it would look like*
- *What rooms or features it would have*

and explain why you would like to live in this house

You will have to talk about the topic for 2 to 3 minutes. You have one minute to think about what you're going to say. You can make some notes to help you if you wish.

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

1. Do you think houses should be built from different materials in the future?
2. Should houses be different for young and old people? Why?
3. Should governments provide more affordable housing for young people?
4. Is it better for families to rent or to buy a house? Why?

SUGGESTIONS

PART 1: INTERVIEW

⇒ *Suggested answers:*

3. Do you live in a house or an apartment?

I live in an apartment in Hanoi. It isn't very big, but it has everything my family needs.

4. How long have you lived there?

I've lived there for about three years. We moved in when I started university, so it feels familiar now.

5. What do you like about living there?

I like that it is convenient because it's near my workplace and shops. I also enjoy the view from the balcony, especially at night when the city is bright.

PART 2: LONG TURN

1. Selection

It is quite difficult to describe city accommodation. It is probably easier to talk about a home in the countryside. (Even if you have never lived in the countryside, you should be able to describe a typical countryside house.)

2. Grammar Point

You **MUST** use type 2 conditional clauses:

If + S + V-ed, S + would/could/should/might + V-inf

- *If I could choose my dream house, I would probably opt for...*
- *It would have...*
- *If I could pick and choose, I would like it to be/ have...*
- *If it were...then I might be able to...*
- *If it had...then I would be able to...*

3. Uncommon Vocabulary

Nouns	Meaning	Example
single-storey	nhà một tầng	<i>The house would be a single-storey home because it feels cozy and easy to move around.</i>
thatched roof	mái nhà lợp rơm rạ	<i>I imagine my dream house in the countryside with a thatched roof, giving it a traditional look.</i>
courtyard	sân trong, sân vườn	<i>My dream house would have a big courtyard where I could grow trees and flowers.</i>
veranda	hiên nhà, mái hiên	<i>I would love a veranda in my house to sit and drink tea in the morning.</i>

Nouns	Meaning	Example
meadow	đồng cỏ, bãi cỏ hoa dại	<i>My dream house would be near a meadow so I could enjoy nature and fresh air every day.</i>
panoramic view	tầm nhìn toàn cảnh	<i>It would have windows with a panoramic view of the sea.</i>
modern amenities	tiện nghi hiện đại	<i>I would like modern amenities such as smart lighting and a home theater.</i>

Verbs	Meaning	Example
decorate	trang trí	<i>I would decorate my dream house with plants and paintings to make it lively.</i>
renovate	cải tạo	<i>If I bought an old house, I would renovate it into my dream house.</i>
furnish	trang bị nội thất	<i>I want to furnish my dream house with simple but comfortable furniture.</i>
overlook	nhìn ra (cảnh)	<i>My dream house would overlook a river so I could enjoy the view every day.</i>
expand	mở rộng	<i>I hope to expand my dream house to add a garden and a guest room.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
spacious	rộng rãi	<i>The house would have a spacious living room for family gatherings.</i>
eco-friendly	thân thiện với môi trường	<i>I want it to be eco-friendly, using solar panels and natural materials.</i>
minimalist	tối giản	<i>I prefer to have a minimalist design with simple furniture.</i>
rustic	mộc mạc, giản dị	<i>My dream house would have a rustic style to feel close to nature.</i>
luxurious	sang trọng	<i>Some people imagine their dream house as a luxurious villa with a swimming pool.</i>

Idioms	Meaning	Example
home sweet home	nhà là nơi ấm áp nhất	<i>No matter where I travel, my dream house would always feel like home sweet home.</i>
a roof over one's head	có chỗ ở	<i>Having a dream house means more than just a roof over my head; it means comfort and security.</i>
build castles in the air	mơ mộng viễn vông	<i>Sometimes, imagining a dream house is just building castles in the air.</i>

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

⇒ *Suggested answers*

1. Do you think houses should be built from different materials in the future?

(Answer) *Yes, I think houses will need new materials in the future.*

(Why) *This is because traditional materials like wood and cement may not be sustainable or eco-friendly enough.*

(Example) *For example, some modern houses are already using recycled plastic or solar panels to reduce energy use.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, some classic materials like brick and stone might still remain popular because they are durable and familiar.*

2. Should houses be different for young and old people? Why?

(Answer) *Yes, I believe houses should be designed differently for different age groups.*

(Why) *Young people often prefer modern apartments with technology and small spaces, while older people may need safer, quieter, and more comfortable homes.*

(Example) *In specific, some elderly people may need houses with ramps and handrails instead of stairs.*

(Opposite) *However, I think all houses should focus on being practical and safe, regardless of age.*

3. Should governments provide more affordable housing for young people?

(Answer) *Yes, I think governments should provide more affordable housing for young people.*

(Why) *There's a fact that many young adults struggle to buy houses because property prices are too high compared to their income.*

(Example) *For example, in big cities like Hanoi or Ho Chi Minh City, young workers often have to rent small rooms because they cannot afford to buy an apartment.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, some people believe the government should not provide cheap housing because it may encourage dependency. They think young people should work hard, save money, and buy houses by themselves instead of relying on public support.*

4. Is it better for families to rent or to buy a house? Why?

(Answer) *In my opinion, buying a house is generally better for families.*

(Why) *Owning a house gives people stability, freedom to design their space, and a valuable long-term investment. (In Vietnam, people often say “an cư lạc nghiệp” — meaning if you have a stable place to live, you can focus on building a successful career and a better life.)*

(Example) *For instance, families with children usually feel more secure when they live in their own home instead of moving from one rental to another.*

(Opposite) *However, renting can sometimes be better for young families who want flexibility, especially if they often change jobs or live in different cities.*